

Questions about *Treatise* III.iii

1. Hume is one of the most important figures in the tradition of *virtue ethics*: for him, the most important moral concepts are the concepts of virtue and vice; he says relatively little about right and wrong, duty and obligation, or good and bad as applied to things other than people's characters. What *does* he say about the connection between virtue and vice and these other moral concepts? Does this seem like a good way to approach ethics?
2. Hume's primary concern in this part is to explain why we consider various character traits to be virtues. What is the role of *sympathy* in these explanations? How successful are these explanations?
3. What new light does the discussion of the 'correction' of sentiments on pp. 580–587 shed on the question what moral judgment consists in, according to Hume?
4. Hume has sometimes been considered as a forerunner of utilitarianism. What are the main points of similarity and difference between Hume's view and utilitarianism? (Ignore this question if you've never taken a course in moral philosophy!)